



### Hyperlocal delivery

Emerging hyperlocal services have gotten a much needed boost after the pandemic. <https://digit.in/aug20-45>



### Delivering food

The need for food delivery services has everyone from MakeMyTrip to ZoomCar jumping in. <https://digit.in/aug20-46>

consultation and prescription services with a registered set of doctors aboard.

### JUMPING ON THE BANDWAGON

Players from different sectors are also working towards enabling the speedy delivery of essential goods now. WayCool Foods is one such example. The farm-to-fork supply chain startup leveraged its supply chain network in over 50 locations across India to



WayCool Foods entered the essentials delivery sector by leveraging its massive food supply network

deliver essentials. Partnering up with the likes of Swiggy and Zomato, the company has ventured into delivering grocery staples, vegetables and fruits. The company has a network of over 40,000 farmers that they source their products directly from. WayCool moves an estimated 250 tonnes of produce per day, as per YourStory and has also delivered more than 34,000 kits to those in need through NGOs.

Food aggregators such as Swiggy and Zomato not only offered their network of delivery people to other companies, but also began experimenting with grocery delivery themselves. Both companies partnered with FMCG companies as well as local stores to provide groceries, vegetables, fruits, meat, and even pet food deliveries straight to the homes of the users. Swiggy incorporated new 'Grocery', 'Fruits and vegetables', 'Meat Stores' and 'Pet Care Stores' tabs in their app that sourced the products from nearby sellers. Zomato incorporated a 'Market' tab that listed nearby grocery and vegetable stores.

Apart from these stakeholders, smaller startups such as Near.Store,

Store Se and WoW! Momos also capitalised on the situation and tweaked their businesses to essentially morph into grocery delivery platforms. It was a necessary measure since these businesses were uncomfortably close to shutting down altogether due to the lack of foot traffic during the lockdown. According to reports, the essentials delivery service, WoW! Momo Essentials contributed to a whopping 50 per cent of WoW! Momos' revenue in the month of May.

### REINVENTING THEMSELVES

Startups that didn't necessarily even have a background in food or other essential products also recognised the opportunity and tweaked their business model in order to enter the lucrative essentials delivery space. An example is the digital credit startup ePayLater that partnered with Zipgrid, a service provider for housing communities, and launched ZipMart. ZipMart allows residential societies registered with Zipgrid to order edibles and other essentials from ePayLater's partner stores in Mumbai and NCR.

NoBroker, an app that facilitates renting, buying and selling residential flats and houses, also delved straight into the supply of daily essentials. A complete 360-degree turn from their original business model, the app now incorporates a grocery services section in its app that allows groceries to be delivered to residential complexes in cities such as Bengaluru, Pune, Chennai and Hyderabad.

Rapido, a bike taxi platform that has a presence in close to 100 cities across the country tweaked their business model as well and began repurposing their bikes to help with the deliveries of essentials. While the company already had an existing partnership with e-commerce and food delivery companies such as Swiggy and Myntra, Rapido also partnered up with major essential delivery players such as Big Basket, Grofers, Spencers, and Big Bazaar. Additionally, the company also leveraged their bikes to

help the Delhi government to deliver essential items such as milk and food packages to the underprivileged. The company recently launched two new services – Rapido Local, a person-to-person delivery service, and Rapido Store, a delivery service for both offline and online businesses to deliver items to customers.

Other companies such as MakeMyTrip and Zoomcar also reinvented themselves and repurposed their business model to enter this arena. Nasdaq-listed MakeMyTrip launched an online gourmet delivery service in tie-up with fine-dining restaurants in Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Bengaluru. Zoomcar, on the other hand, leveraged their cars to begin delivering essentials for Big Basket, Grofers and MilkBasket.

While we cannot be sure, as of now, if most of these companies will continue to keep this portion of their business alive even after the lockdown ends, the quick shift and re-modelling of their business structure



Rapido, a bike taxi startup also entered the essentials delivery space by leveraging their network of bikes across cities in India

have helped many Indian startups and companies stay afloat during the lockdown. Not only that, they have also eased the woes of companies that are existing players in this space by providing extra delivery riders, vehicles, supply and much more. The end result is that customers that are relegated to the confines of their home during these troubled times are able to get deliveries of essential items much faster than what could be achieved by the pre-Covid network of essentials delivery services. 